

Programming for Economist

PS 1

Class 9

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August 2026

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Plan for today

1. Working with problem sets
2. Intro to VSCode
3. Tips for PS1

1. Working with problem sets

- Problem sets are difficult and have many solutions
- Use code from lectures, previous exercises, friends, stack overflow etc.
 - Use what you can, modify and discard the rest
 - Important you understand why the code works as intended
- If you get stuck
 1. Read the documentation
 2. Play around with the code
 3. Look at solution
 4. Ask me/an LLM
- Highly recommended to work in groups, but write your own code

2. VSCode

1. Open VSCode and follow along on your own computer.

3. Tips for PS1

- Q1
 - To create a function, you use:
`def function_name(inputs):`
 `return output`
 - "to the power of" in python is `**`, e.g. `x**2`
- Q2
 - A string with an `f` before it is called an fstring –written `f'string'`
 - You can put references inside an f-string via `"{}"`
 - You format references by `{object:format}`
 - Use the following format for the utility-values `"6.3f"`
 - This formats floats into 6 characters wide and 3 decimals
 - `Enumerate` returns the index and value from an array

3. Tips for PS1

- Q3

- Use:

- `with open('file location and name', 'w') as f:`
 - `f.write(what you want to write)`
 - `'w'` is for write, and `f` is arbitrary but normal for `'file'`
 - Remember to specify file type here `'txt'`

- Q4

- Use:

- `with open('file location and name ', 'r') as f:`
 - `print(f.read())`

3. Tips for PS1

- Q5
 - Use code from lectures as inspiration
 - Start by defining a function computing indifference curves(x_2 as function of x_1 and utility)
 - Then create an array with x_1 's, and looping over betas and utility you compute x_2 using the function and indexing over a Boolean, to make sure points are within the constraint.
 - Useful functions
 - `np.linspace`
 - Use for-loops with `enumerate`
 - Use Jeppe's or my code for plot inspiration/cosmetics
- Q6
 - Similar to Q5 but instead of using the vectors you need to make a grid of possible x_1 's and x_2 's at the same time using `meshgrid` on the vectors.
 - Use: `ax.plot_surface`, and `ax.contour` if you don't want to compute utility yourself

3. Tips for PS1

- Q7
 - Similar to Q6 with a mesh grid and still indexing for feasible points, this time using the budget constraint.
 - Use:
 - `h = ax.scatter(inputs,c=u_grid)`
 - `fig.colorbar(h)`
 - To create the colour grid